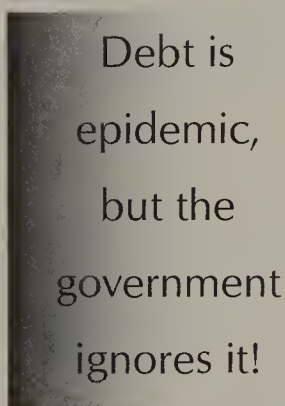


The Debt Epidemic

The United States takes pride in breaking records. Here's one we should not be proud of: American household debt – our credit cards, our mortgage loans, our student loans, our car loans – is at an all-time high. We are \$6.7 trillion in debt and it is increasing by \$2 billion each day! That statistic alone should make someone in Washington take notice!



Debt is
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but the
government
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Credit card issuers, banks, and mortgage companies have no trouble sleeping at night while the average U.S. citizen lies awake, worrying about bills. The average college graduate now enters the workforce already behind the eight ball, with more than \$2000 racked up in credit card debt alone, not including their student loans. I've heard that the average working person spends 90% of their disposable income toward paying off their debts.

The average bank executive drives a Mercedes and drops \$1000 per plate on a campaign fundraiser dinner.

Debt in this country is an epidemic; it is like a disease that is spreading out of control, and even taking innocent lives. Instead of trying to find a cure, the government looks the other way and ignores the problems of the ordinary working person. The people in Washington make excuses to protect their banking buddies, whose banks are setting record profits, by the way. What is worse, they try to point the finger of blame at me and you.

Many of the ails that we experience in life are brought on by the burden of our debt. The debt bears a much heavier weight than we realize. The ugly feeling of helplessness creeps in and we feel stressed out all the time and we get anxious over every little thing. We can't sleep or we don't want to get out of bed; we may experience any number of personal issues. It should not be happening. We should not have to live our lives under such oppression. People look to the government in times of crisis. In this case, the government is part of the cause of the crisis.

"A government of the people, by the people, for the people" – not anymore; unless, of course, the people referred to are the consumer